

Project Presentation Overview and Guidelines

What was the system? → What risks did we discover? → How did we analyze them? → What did we fix? → What did we learn?

For a 10-15-minute presentation, I would recommend **10–12 slides maximum** plus a live demo.

Suggested Presentation Flow (10 minutes)

Slide 1: Title & Team Introduction (30 sec)

- Project name
- Team members and roles
- Travelers logo
- One-sentence project summary

Example:

"Secure Web Application Assessment and Remediation Project"

Slide 2: Project Overview (45 sec)

Answer:

- What is the application?
- Who are the users?
- What problem does it solve?

Include:

- Objectives
- Scope
- Deliverables

Example:

"We analyzed a web application for security weaknesses, performed threat modeling, identified vulnerabilities, and implemented mitigations."

Slide 3: Architecture / System Design (1 min)

Visual diagram preferred.

Show:

- User
- Frontend
- Backend/API
- Database
- Authentication
- External services

Explain:

- Data flow
- Trust boundaries

Audience should immediately understand:

"How does data move through this system?"

Slide 4: Tools & Technologies (45 sec)

Create a simple table:

Tool	Purpose
Git	Version Control
Node.js	Backend Runtime
React	Frontend
Express	API Framework
Passport.js	Authentication
Helmet	Security Headers
OpenSSL	Certificates
Postman	API Testing
OWASP ZAP	Security Testing

Focus on:

- Why each tool mattered
 - Security-specific tools
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Slide 5: Threat Model (1 min)

This is usually where judges/instructors pay attention.

Follow Travelers template:

Include:

Assets

- User accounts
- Session tokens
- Database records

Actors

- Legitimate users
- Administrators
- External attackers

Entry Points

- Login page
- API endpoints
- User input forms

Data Flow Diagram

Simple DFD:

```
User
  |
Frontend
  |
API Server
  |
Database
```

Highlight trust boundaries.

Slide 6: STRIDE Analysis (1 min)

Create a matrix:

Threat	Example
Spoofing	Stolen credentials

Threat	Example
Tampering	Modified requests
Repudiation	Lack of audit logs
Information Disclosure	Sensitive data exposure
Denial of Service	Excessive requests
Elevation of Privilege	Admin access bypass

Highlight the threats most relevant to your application.

Slide 7: Vulnerabilities Identified (1 min)

This is the "aha" slide.

Example:

Vulnerability	Risk
Missing Authentication	High
Weak Session Handling	Medium
Missing Security Headers	Medium
Input Validation Issues	High
Sensitive Error Messages	Low

Show screenshots if possible.

Demonstrate:

- Discovery method
 - Impact
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Slide 8: Mitigations Implemented (1 min)

Pair each vulnerability with its fix.

Issue	Solution
Missing Auth	Passport.js Authentication
XSS Risk	Input Sanitization
Missing Headers	Helmet
Session Weakness	Secure Cookies

Issue	Solution
Exposed Errors	Centralized Error Handling

This slide shows actual engineering work.

Slide 9: Challenges & Learnings (45 sec)

Challenges

- Limited project time
- Learning unfamiliar tools
- Threat modeling for the first time
- Debugging security controls

Learnings

Before:

- Basic web development

After:

- STRIDE
- DREAD
- OWASP concepts
- Secure authentication
- Defense-in-depth

This directly addresses:

"What did you learn and apply?"

Slide 10: Live Demo (2 min)

Most important slide.

Demonstrate:

Before Fix

- Vulnerability exists

Example:

- Access protected route without authentication
- Unsanitized input
- Missing headers

After Fix

- Protection works

Example:

- Authentication enforced
- Input rejected
- Security headers present

Future Improvements

Be realistic:

"Given another week, we would implement MFA, automated security testing, and rate limiting."

That honesty is usually viewed positively.

Slide 11: References

Include:

- OWASP Top 10
 - OWASP Cheat Sheets
 - Node.js Documentation
 - Express Documentation
 - Passport.js Documentation
 - Helmet Documentation
 - Course materials
 - Travelers Threat Modeling Template
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Slide 12: Q&A

Instead of:

"Any questions?"

Use:

"If you were conducting the next security review, which threat would you investigate first?"

or

"What additional controls would you prioritize if this application handled sensitive customer data?"

These prompts often generate more discussion than a generic Q&A invitation.

What Evaluators Are Really Looking For

Your presentation should repeatedly answer four questions:

1. **What security risks existed?**
2. **How did you identify them?**
3. **How did you mitigate them?**
4. **What did you learn from the process?**

A strong closing statement is:

"Our project moved beyond simply building an application. We applied secure software engineering principles, performed threat modeling, identified realistic attack vectors, and implemented practical mitigations. The result was a more secure system and a deeper understanding of modern application security."

That directly aligns with the reminder:

"Showcase that you learned and applied what you learned in a productive way."